Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 11 expectations

Grade 11 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 11 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Draft: to be checked by a teacher before use.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.11-12.2, L.11-12.2a, L.11-12.2b

A worked example

Correct this sentence, using a semicolon: the well known author visited abu dhabi however she stayed only one day

1. Capital letters for the names of places and for the start of the sentence: Abu Dhabi.
2. Before a noun, a compound adjective is hyphenated: well-known author.
3. However joins two complete sentences, so a semicolon goes before it and a comma after it.
4. End with a full stop.

The well-known author visited Abu Dhabi; however, she stayed only one day.

Questions

1. Choose the correct form: The (well known / well-known) author spoke at the book fair in Sharjah.

2. Punctuate it with a semicolon: Salem packed his bag early however the bus was late.

3. Add the missing colon: Hind packed three things for the trip a map, a flask of karak and a hat.

4. Which spelling is correct: occurence, occurrence or occurance?

5. Choose the right word: The new metro line will (complement / compliment) the bus routes.

6. Choose the right word: The committee agreed on the (principal / principle) that every member deserves a fair hearing.

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7. Correct the punctuation, using American style: Omar described the view from the top of Jebel Jais as "breathtaking".

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8. Show how the titles should be marked: Layla read the article Desert Gardens in the magazine Gulf Science.

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9. Choose the correctly hyphenated phrase: (a) a twenty five year old falcon (b) a twenty-five-year-old falcon (c) a twenty-five year old falcon

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10. Correct the three spelling mistakes: The goverment made a necesary change to the schedual.

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11. Punctuate this list, where some items already contain commas: The exhibition travelled to Abu Dhabi, the capital, Al Ain, the oasis city, and Fujairah, on the east coast.

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12. Explain the difference in meaning between these sentences, and say what the hyphen does: (1) Omar re-covered the sofa. (2) Omar recovered the sofa.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.11-12.1, L.11-12.1a, L.11-12.1b, L.11-12.3, L.11-12.3a

A worked example

Correct the dangling modifier: Walking along the creek, the dhows looked beautiful to Layla.

1. The opening phrase Walking along the creek must describe the person who is walking.
2. The dhows are not walking, so Layla must come right after the comma.
3. Rewrite the main clause with Layla as its subject.

Walking along the creek, Layla thought the dhows looked beautiful.

Questions

1. Choose the right word: The scientist with (who / whom) Hind discussed the project works at a solar park.

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2. Choose the right word: There were (fewer / less) visitors at the museum this week than last week.

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3. Choose the right word: The Hope Probe, (that / which) reached Mars orbit in 2021, is studying the planet's atmosphere.

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4. Correct the parallel structure: Hamdan likes swimming, to cycle and playing football.

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5. Correct the parallel structure: The trip was both educational and it was fun.

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6. Choose the right verb: The collection of rare coins (is / are) on display at the museum.

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7. Which sentence is parallel? (a) The camp taught us to read maps, to pitch tents and cooking meals. (b) The camp taught us to read maps, to pitch tents and to cook meals.

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8. Correct the faulty comparison: The metro's route is longer than the tram.

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9. Revise for concision without changing the meaning: At this point in time, the museum is in the process of expanding its collection.

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10. Combine the two sentences into one, using a relative clause: Noura visited the Louvre Abu Dhabi. It opened in 2017.

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11. Fix the comma splice in three different ways: The souq opens at nine, Salem arrived early.

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12. Rewrite the sentence so that it is in the active voice, then say which version a writer might choose if the doer is not important: The solar park was completed in the spring.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.11-12.1, W.11-12.1a, W.11-12.1b, W.11-12.1c, W.11-12.1e, W.11-12.2, W.11-12.2a, W.11-12.2c, W.11-12.2d, W.11-12.3, W.11-12.3a, W.11-12.3b, W.11-12.5

A worked example

Improve this thesis so that it is more precise and takes the opposing view into account: Cycling lanes are good.

1. Say exactly what is being claimed: new cycling lanes should be built in UAE cities.
2. Give the main reason: they cut traffic and keep people healthy.
3. Recognise the other side with although: some drivers worry about losing road space.
4. Join these in one sentence.

Although some drivers worry about losing road space, UAE cities should build more cycling lanes because they reduce traffic and encourage healthy daily exercise.

Questions

1. Which thesis is more nuanced? (a) Social media is bad. (b) Although social media helps students keep in touch with family, schools should teach them to limit its use because constant notifications reduce focus.

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2. Write a thesis statement for an essay arguing that more shaded walkways should be built in your city. It should state a clear position and acknowledge an opposing view.

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3. Write a counterclaim and a rebuttal for this claim: School should start later in the morning.

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4. Choose the best transition: Desalination provides fresh water for homes and farms. ____, it uses a great deal of energy. (Similarly / Nevertheless / For instance / Consequently)

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5. Which sentence introduces a source better? (a) "Oryx numbers have risen steadily." (b) The reserve's annual report notes, "Oryx numbers have risen steadily."

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6. Write a topic sentence for an informative paragraph about how the Hope Probe studies the atmosphere of Mars.

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7. Put these sentences in a logical order to explain how desalination works. (A) Seawater is drawn in from the Gulf. (B) Fresh water is piped to homes. (C) Pressure pushes the seawater through membranes that hold back the salt. (D) The fresh water is tested to make sure it is safe.

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8. Revise for precise language and a formal tone: Lots of people think the new park is kind of awesome.

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9. Write the opening of a narrative that engages the reader and sets the scene. The narrator is Maryam, who is hiking in the Hajar Mountains with her father and her cousins.

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10. Name the narrative technique: A story set in Dubai in the present day stops to show, in a few paragraphs, a scene from the narrator's childhood in Fujairah, and then returns to the present.

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11. Which concluding sentence best ends an argument essay on building more public libraries? (a) That is all I have to say. (b) In short, public libraries give every family free access to knowledge, and a city that invests in them invests in its future. (c) Another point is that some libraries sell coffee.

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12. Revise this message for a parent newsletter so that the tone suits the audience and purpose: "Yo, the museum trip is gonna be epic, so bring some cash."

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. well-known (a compound adjective placed before a noun takes a hyphen; after the noun it would not, as in The author is well known)
2. Salem packed his bag early; however, the bus was late. (a semicolon joins two complete sentences, and a comma follows the transition however)
3. Hind packed three things for the trip: a map, a flask of karak and a hat. (a colon follows a complete sentence and introduces a list)
4. occurrence (two c's and two r's, ending in -ence)
5. complement (it means to complete or go well with; a compliment is an expression of praise)
6. principle (a rule or belief; principal means main, or the head of a school)
7. Omar described the view from the top of Jebel Jais as "breathtaking." (in American style, commas and full stops go inside the closing quotation marks)
8. Layla read the article "Desert Gardens" in the magazine Gulf Science. (the title of a short work goes in quotation marks; the title of a longer work such as a magazine is in italics, or underlined when handwritten)
9. (b). When a number and a unit are joined to describe a noun, every part of the compound adjective is linked by hyphens.
10. The government made a necessary change to the schedule. (govern-ment, one c and two s's in necessary, and schedule ends in -ule)
11. The exhibition travelled to Abu Dhabi, the capital; Al Ain, the oasis city; and Fujairah, on the east coast. (semicolons separate the items when the items themselves contain commas)
12. (1) means Omar put a new cover on the sofa, or covered it again. (2) means Omar got the sofa back after it was lost or taken. The hyphen shows the two-part meaning "cover again" and separates it from the different word recovered.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. whom (it is the object of the preposition with; test it: Hind discussed the project with her or him)
2. fewer (use fewer with things you can count, and less with amounts that cannot be counted)
3. which (extra information set off by commas is introduced by which, never by that)
4. Hamdan likes swimming, cycling and playing football. (all items in a list should have the same form)
5. The trip was both educational and fun. (the words after both and and must be the same kind of word or phrase)
6. is (the subject is the singular noun collection; of rare coins is only a phrase that describes it)
7. (b). Every item in the series has the same form (to plus a verb).
8. The metro's route is longer than the tram's. or: ...longer than that of the tram. (a route should be compared with a route, not with a vehicle)

9. Model answer: The museum is expanding its collection. (the wordy phrases at this point in time and is in the process of add nothing)
10. Model answer: Noura visited the Louvre Abu Dhabi, which opened in 2017. (any correct single sentence that keeps both ideas is fine)
11. Any three of these: The souq opens at nine; Salem arrived early. / The souq opens at nine. Salem arrived early. / The souq opens at nine, and Salem arrived early. / Although the souq opens at nine, Salem arrived early. (a comma alone cannot join two complete sentences)
12. Active version, with an invented doer: Engineers completed the solar park in the spring. A writer might keep the passive version when the doer is unknown or less important than the result. (both choices are correct; the style depends on what the writer wants to emphasise)

Section 3: Writing

1. (b). It takes a clear position, gives a reason and admits a fair point on the other side. (a) is vague and one-sided.
2. A good answer has a precise claim, a main reason, and a fair mention of the other side. Model: Although shaded walkways cost money to build, our city should add more of them because they make walking safer and more comfortable in the summer heat. Answers will vary.
3. A good answer states a fair opposing view and answers it with a reason or evidence. Model: Some people say a later start would make the school day end too late for after-school activities. However, the day could be kept the same length by shortening the breaks, and students who sleep longer concentrate better. Answers will vary.
4. Nevertheless (the second sentence adds a drawback, so a transition showing contrast is needed)
5. (b). A signal phrase tells the reader where the quotation comes from. Quotations should be introduced and attributed, not dropped in alone.
6. A good answer names the topic and prepares the reader for the details. Model: The Hope Probe studies the Martian atmosphere by using its instruments to measure how the weather changes throughout the day and across the seasons. Answers will vary.
7. A, C, D, B (water is drawn in, filtered, tested, and only then delivered)
8. Model answer: Many residents consider the new park an impressive addition to the neighbourhood. (a good answer removes slang and vague words and keeps the meaning)
9. A good answer puts the reader in a clear setting and introduces the narrator and the situation with sensory details. Model: The path above the wadi was loose gravel, and every step sent small stones clattering down the slope below us. Papa led the way, my cousins joked in a line after him, and I held tight to the water bottle, because I was sure the real adventure was about to begin. Answers will vary.
10. A flashback (it moves back in time to give background, then returns to the main timeline)
11. (b). It restates the position, ties it to a larger meaning, and does not add a new, unrelated point. (a) is empty and (c) brings in an unrelated idea.

12. A good answer is polite, clear and formal, and gives the reader what they need to know. Model: Our class trip to the museum is coming up, and students are asked to bring money for lunch. Answers will vary.